

Tech Radar - Observability



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Status

draft

Summary

Tooling to support observability is a key consideration for running live services.

Within NHS England we should consider the following options for Observability when building and operating services:

Solution	Features	Good For	Cons
ODIN	Centralised Observability. Best in class Dashboarding. Best in class Alerting System. Custom Metrics. Supports all Open Telemetry types and more. High Volume Logs, Metrics, Traces & Profiles. Cross Service Observability. Cross Account Observability.	All services including National Infrastructure & High Availability Services.	

Solution	Features	Good For	Cons
	ITOC / Tech Ops Centralised Monitoring. High Availability. Cost Effective at scale.		
Cloud Native	Local Service Observability. High Availability. Good Out of the Box support for cloud native services.	As a complement to ODIN. Additional Team Local Observability. Triggering automated actions.	Not centralised. Can be expensive, pay per query & custom metrics costs can be high. Dashboarding & Alerting capabilities basic. Can require significant development. Cloud provider lock in.
Grafana LGTM Stack - Self hosted.	Full local observability stack. Best in class Dashboarding. Custom Metrics. Supports all Open Telemetry types and more. Low Volume Logs, Metrics, Traces & Profiles.	Local Development & Testing Low availability Team Local observability.	Not centralised. Configuration Complex beyond simple low volume patterns. Teams should use ODIN beyond simple local use cases. Low Availability.
Grafana & Prometheus - Self Hosted	Local metrics stack. Best in class Dashboarding. Custom Metrics. Low Volume Metrics.	Local Development & Testing of metrics.	Low Availability.

If you are considering options around Observability please speak to the Odin team.

Further information for Observability tooling

Governance audit:

- Classification of Prometheus/Grafana as "[mainstream](#)" scheduled for approval by Engineering Board at 24-04-2026
- Justification for mainstream status

Funding model:

- TBD

Visibility:

- Teams should consider how they best make their logs visible to ITOC for overall service health reporting.